Root cause analysis

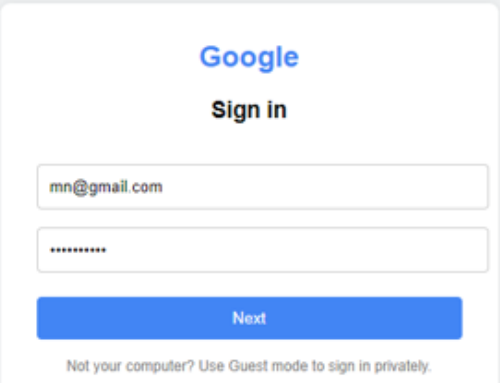
Containment, Eradication, and Recovery

Root Cause Analysis:

A phishing attack that relied on social engineering techniques.

The user was deceived by a spoofed email and accessed a fake login page hosted on a malicious domain.

The lack of user awareness and absence of email filtering contributed to the success of the attack.



Dear Manal,

We detected **unusual activity** on your account, and immediate action is required to prevent suspension.

Please **verify** your account by clicking the link below:

http://microsoft-support-login.com

Failure to verify your account within 24 hours may result in temporary suspension.

If you did not request this action, please ignore this email.

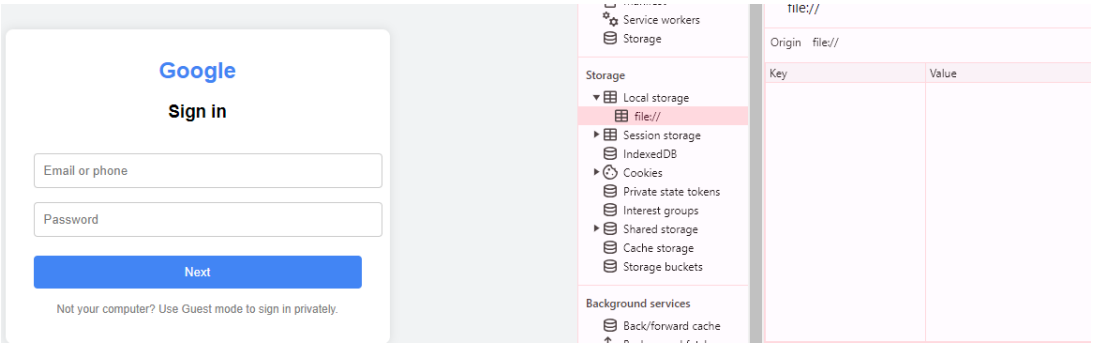
Best regards,
IT Support Team
Microsoft Security Department

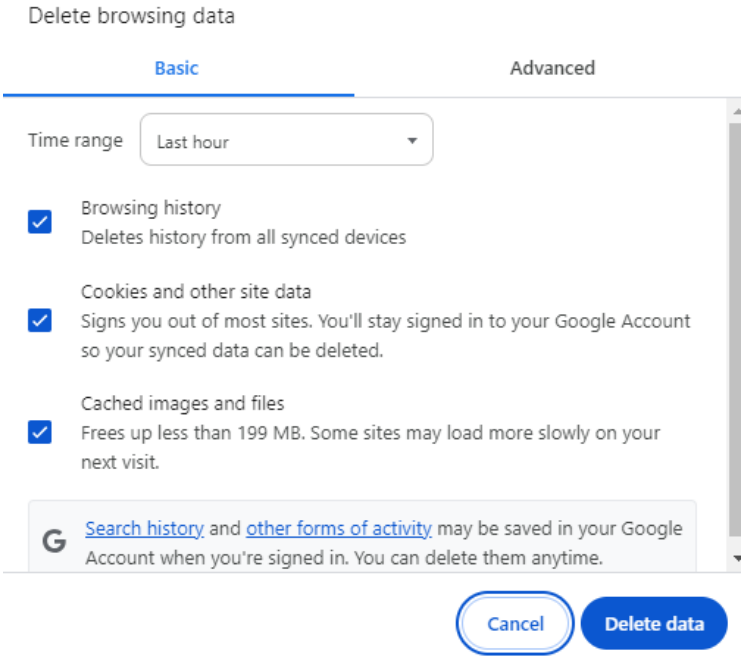
Containment Steps:

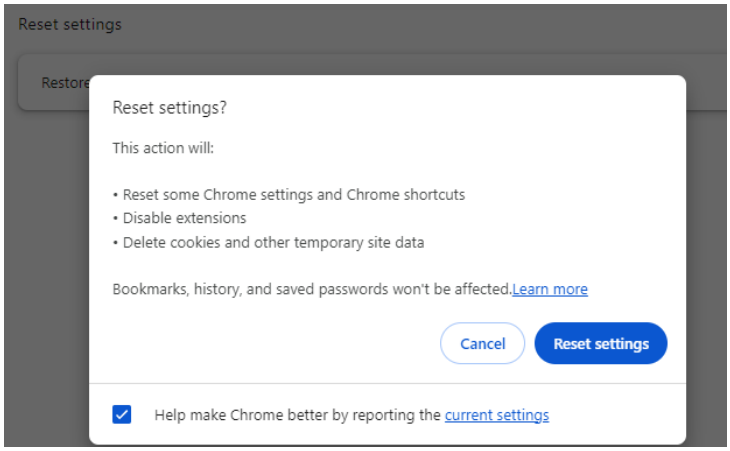
The affected system was immediately isolated by closing the phishing page and terminating browser activity.

Browser data, including local storage and history, was cleared to prevent further data exposure.

The malicious domain was identified and blocked.







Eradication Steps:

The phishing artifacts, including the fake login page (index.html) and malicious domain mapping, were removed from the system.

The hosts file was cleaned by deleting the unauthorized entry that redirected the spoofed domain.

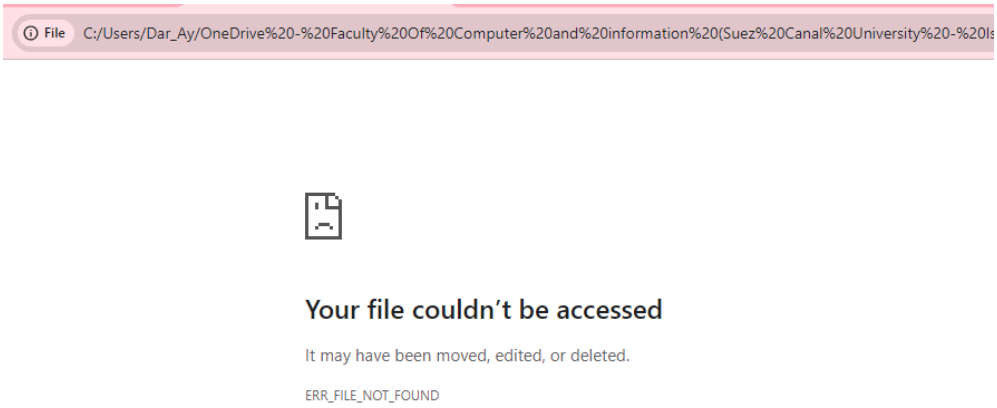
Ensured that all components related to the phishing simulation were fully eliminated.

```
# localhost name resolution is handled within DNS itself.
#       127.0.0.1       localhost
#       ::1             localhost
127.0.0.1   microsoft-support-login.com
```

```
# localhost name resolution is handled within DNS itself.
#       127.0.0.1       localhost
#       ::1             localhost
```

Recovery Steps:

The system was restored to normal operation after removing all malicious artifacts. The browser was tested to ensure no redirection to phishing pages occurred, and a system restart was performed to apply changes. No further suspicious activity was detected, confirming that the environment is now secure.



The incident was successfully contained, the root cause was identified and all malicious components were removed.

The system was restored to a secure state.